

How We Utilized The Sustainability Ux Principles

1. Design for ecosystems, not just users

We realised that e-waste is not only a user problem; it involves retailers, refurbishers, recyclers, NGOs, manufacturers and the planet. Our solution therefore connects these actors rather than solving only the user's disposal problem.

2. Understand the negative impacts

Mapping the device journey helped us see that the impact does not begin when a device reaches the bin—it builds through production, replacement, storage and disposal. We therefore focused on keeping usable devices in circulation for longer.

3. Sustainability is more than carbon

Our research showed that sustainability also involves consumption, accessibility, economic value and social impact. E-flip therefore creates value for the user, retailer, circular ecosystem and environment together.

4. Design for equality

A sustainable option is only useful when people can actually access and understand it. We explored a simple, physical retail touchpoint so users do not need specialised knowledge or a separate digital platform to participate.

5. Design for wellbeing and fairness

We learnt that encouraging sustainable behaviour should not mean manipulating users into a choice. E-flip makes the available outcomes—sell, donate, keep or explore refurbished—visible so the user can make an informed decision.

6. Design for sustainable users

Instead of asking users to make an extra effort to be sustainable, we brought sustainable choices into an existing retail journey. The goal is to make the responsible pathway convenient enough to become a realistic everyday choice.

7. Solve the right problem

We initially looked at e-waste as a disposal problem, but our journey mapping showed another opportunity: many devices are discarded or stored before their useful life is actually over. This shifted our focus from “How do we recycle it?” to “How do we keep it useful?”

8. Design for less

Our Impact-Effort mapping made us realise that sustainability does not require endless features. We prioritised the few interactions that create the most value—assessment, clear choices, remaining-life information and simple next-life pathways.

9. Make sustainability the default

Sustainability works better when it is built into the experience rather than presented as an additional “green” option. In e-flip, assessment, reuse, refurbishment and impact tracking are part of the core journey itself.

10. Design new narratives

We wanted to move away from the idea that old technology is simply “waste.” E-flip reframes it as something that can still hold value, have another user, and contribute to a circular business model.

11. Sustainability needs to create value

Our business-model exploration showed us that sustainability and business value do not have to be separate. A circular system can create value through refurbished products, accessories, customer engagement and new pathways for returned devices.